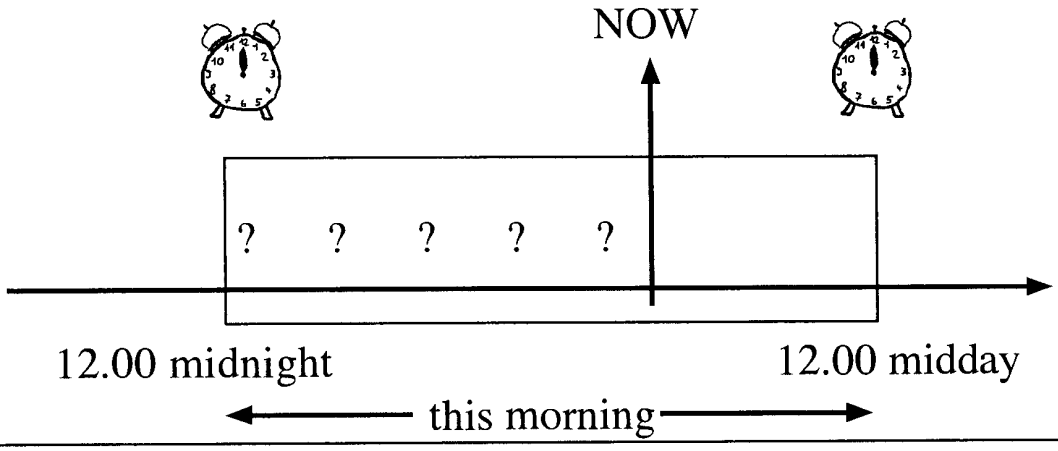
Present Perfect Simple - Unfinished Past
unfinished period of time use

Have you seen Joe this morning?



Concept
The Present Perfect Simple is used to talk about things that have happened in an unfinished period of time that includes the present. It is used with expressions like *this morning, this week, this month, this year.*

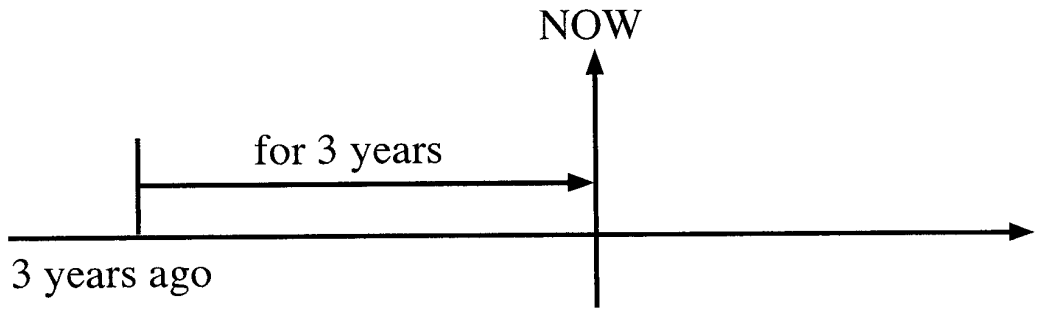
Concept Questions

1 Is it still this morning? (Yes)
2 What do we say in the afternoon? (Did you see Joe this morning?)
3 Why? (Because the morning has finished and there is no longer any connection with the present)

See Practice Materials E(i), E(ii), G

Present Perfect Simple - Unfinished Past
duration use

She *has worked* here for 3 years.



Concept
The Present Perfect Simple is used to talk about the duration of an action that started in the past and continues up to and includes the present. It is often used with *for* and *since*. To ask questions we use "How long have you ....?"

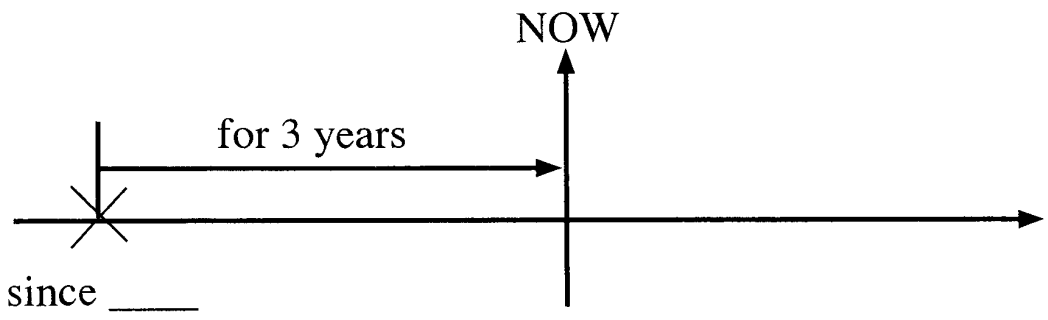
Concept Questions

1 Do we know when the action started? (Yes)
2 Does the action continue up to and include the present? (Yes)
3 Does she still work there? (Yes)
4 What are we interested in? (The duration of the action)

See Practice Materials E(i), E(ii), F, G, I

FOR vs SINCE

She has worked here *for* 3 years.
She has worked here *since* ____.



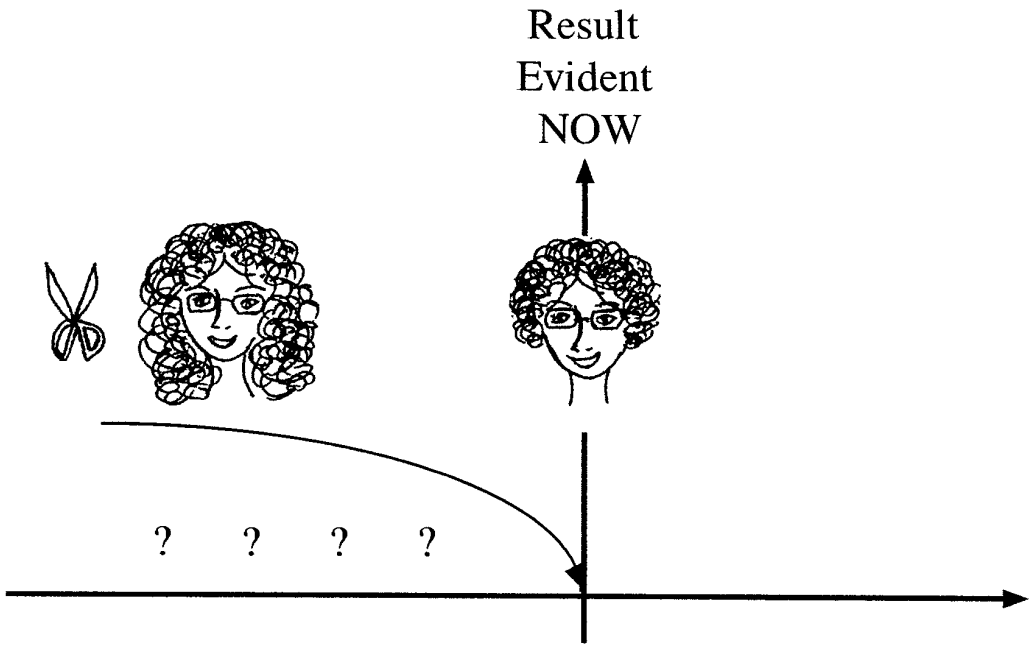
FOR + *a period of time*
eg for 3 years

SINCE + *a specific point in time*
eg since ____

See Practice Material F

Present Perfect Simple - Indefinite Past
result use

"Oh, you *have cut* your hair."



Concept
The Present Perfect is used to talk about the present result of an action completed at an unspecified time in the past.

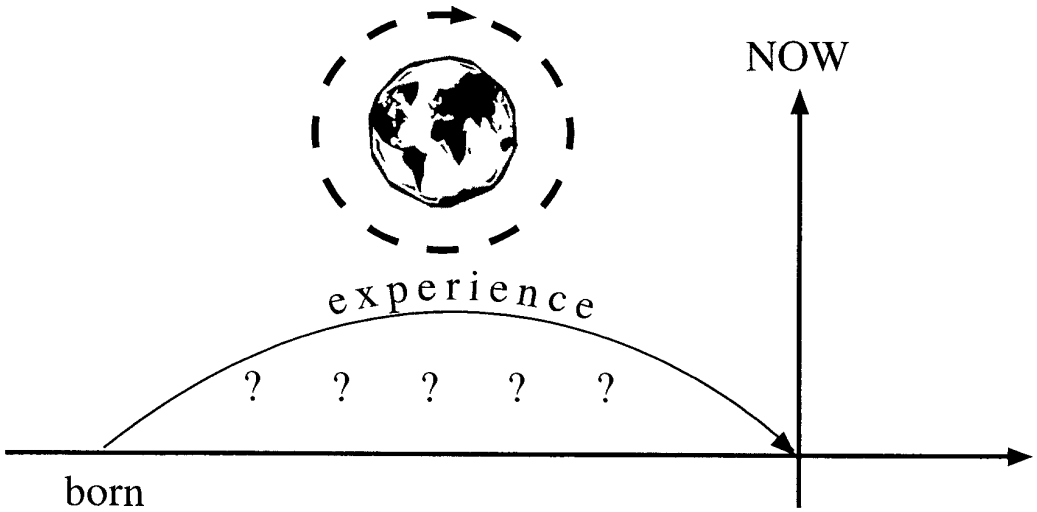
Concept Questions

1 Did something happen in the past? (Yes)
2 Do we know when it happened? (No)
3 Is there a result in the present? (Yes)

See Practice Materials E(i), E(ii), G, I

Present Perfect Simple - Indefinite Past
experience use

He *has travelled* all round the world.



Concept
The Present Perfect Simple is used to talk about experiences people have had at some time in their lives. When it happened is not specified. It can be used with *ever* and *never*, eg "Have you ever...?" "I've never...".

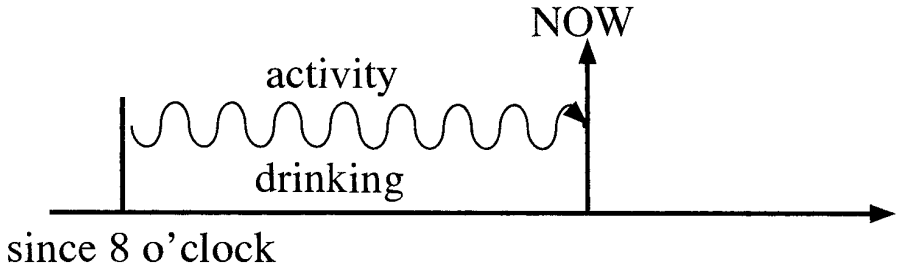
Concept Questions

1 Did he travel round the world at some time in his life? (Yes)
2 Do we know when he did this? (No)
3 Is he still alive? (Yes)
4 So is this experience still with him in the present? (Yes)
5 What do we say when he is no longer alive? (He travelled)

See Practice Materials E(i), E(ii), G, H(i), H(ii), I

Present Perfect Continuous
Unfinished Past
duration of activity use

He *has been* drinking since 8 o'clock.



Concept
The Present Perfect Continuous is used to talk about the duration of an activity that started in the past and continues up to and includes the present. It is often used with *for* and *since*. To ask questions we use "How long have you ....?"

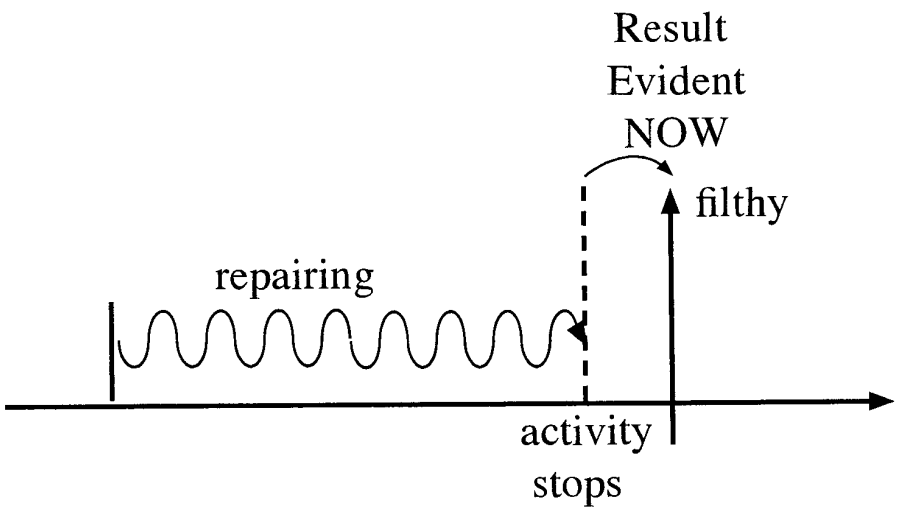
Concept Questions

1 Do we know when the activity started? (Yes)
2 Does the activity continue up to and include the present? (Yes)
3 Is the action still continuing? (Yes)
4 What are we interested in? (The duration of the activity)

See Practice Materials J(i), J(ii), K

Present Perfect Continuous
Indefinite Past
result of a recently stopped activity

He *has been* repairing the car. He's filthy.



Concept
The Present Perfect Continuous is used to talk about the result of a recently stopped activity. The result of the activity is evident in the present.

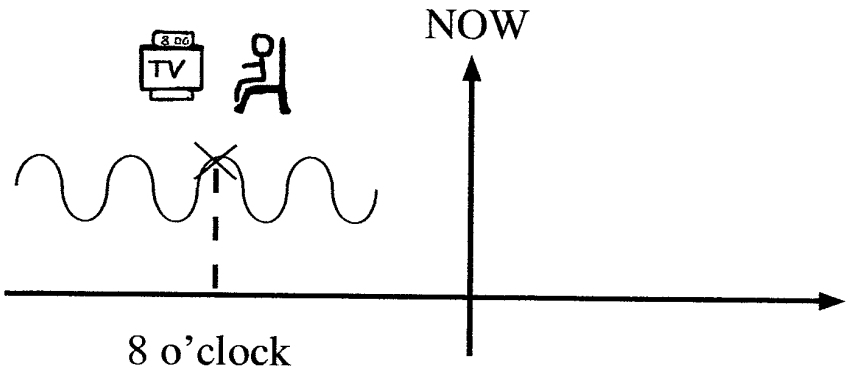
Concept Questions

1 Does the car now work? (Maybe yes, maybe no. We don't know)
2 Is the man repairing the car now? (No)
3 Did he stop repairing the car a short time ago? (Yes)
4 How do we know? (He's filthy)

See Practice Materials J(i), J(ii), K

Past Continuous
an action in progress at a past point in time

I *was watching* TV at 8 o'clock.



Concept
The Past Continuous is used to talk about an action that was in progress at a past point in time.

Concept Questions

1 Did I start watching TV before 8 o'clock? (Yes)
2 Was I still watching TV after 8 o'clock? (Yes)
3 So was this action in progress at 8 o'clock? (Yes)